

Data Compendium

Deep Tech Commercialization at Early TRL Statistical Evidence, Charts, and Raw Data

NCCR Muoniverse Innovation Platform

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Milestone 1 · July 2026

Contents

1. Evidence Base Overview
2. Market Identification: The Binding Constraint
3. Ecosystem Dependency: Knowledge and Talent
4. Incubation Effectiveness: Meta-Analysis Findings
5. Advisor Effects: Business vs Technology Advisors
6. TTO Effectiveness: What Predicts Survival
7. Swiss Ecosystem: Performance and Positioning
8. Innosuisse: Instrument-Level Performance Data
9. Innosuisse: Causal Effect (KOF DiD Study)
10. Framework Comparison: TRL Coverage and Scoring
11. Europe vs US: Structural Barriers
12. Deep Tech Resource Requirements
13. Complete Evidence Table (All Sources)
14. Source List

1. Evidence Base Overview

This compendium presents the full statistical evidence underlying the Milestone 1 literature review and framework assessment. All data is drawn directly from source papers and institutional reports. Every figure is sourced, no data has been estimated or extrapolated.

Composition of the 53-source evidence base

Tier	Description	Count	Examples
Core academic	Peer-reviewed, rigorous methods, directly relevant	17	J. Technology Transfer, Small Business Economics, Review of Managerial Science
Institutional	Primary data from agencies/institutions	6	Innosuisse Impact Monitor, CERN KT Highlights, KOF/SBFI Report
Supporting	Industry reports, working papers, case studies	16	Stryber, UNDP, Hello Tomorrow, RAEng/Beauhurst
Context	Background sources providing Swiss/EU context	5	European Spinout Report, ETH Board, EPFL, PSI
Additional R2	Round 2 additions (12 new academic + 6 institutional)	18	Denoo, Chen, Hayter, Cantner, DTON, Bareš Playbook

Of the 53 sources, 33 have been fully extracted (complete text read and coded). The remaining 20 are at abstract-only level, primarily behind paywalls requiring HSG library access.

2. Market Identification: The Binding Constraint

The most practically important finding across the entire evidence base is that market features, not technology quality, not team quality, not funding availability, are the strongest predictor of deep tech commercialization success. This finding is supported by multiple independent studies using different methods.

2.1 Quantitative Evidence: Foresight (2024)

Regression analysis of 110 European deep tech companies (EIC Accelerator applicants) using PLS-SEM methodology. The model explains 47% of variance in enhanced foresight capabilities ($R^2 = 0.47$).

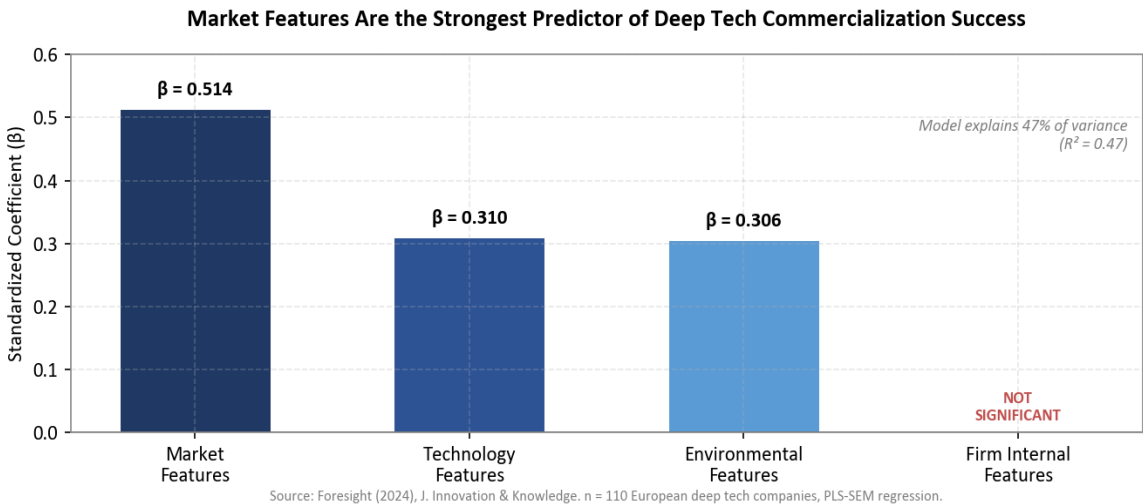


Figure 1. Standardized coefficients (β) for predictors of commercialization success. Market features dominate. Source: Foresight (2024), J. Innovation & Knowledge.

2.2 Full Regression Results

Predictor	β (standardized)	Significance	Interpretation
Market Features	0.514	Significant	Strongest driver , customer need, market size, competitive position
Technology Features	0.310	Significant	Ensuring tech feasibility to scale lab→pilot (outer weight = 0.894)
Environmental Features	0.306	Significant	Regulatory scanning highest (outer loading = 0.804)
Firm Internal Features	,	NOT significant	Team quality, management capability, org structure do NOT predict success

2.3 Corroborating Evidence: Cantner et al. (2024)

Dominance analysis of 1,149 scientists from Thuringia, Germany. The commercial sphere (industry contacts, commercial experience, market knowledge) dominates the academic sphere (research networks, publication record, scientific reputation) in importance from the very outset of spin-off creation, not in later stages, from day one.

Phase	Academic sphere	Commercial sphere	Dominant
1. Research → Opportunity recognition	Present but declining	Present and increasing	COMMERCIAL
2. Opportunity → Refining concept	Declining further	At peak	COMMERCIAL

Phase	Academic sphere	Commercial sphere	Dominant
3. Establishment → Founding entity	Lowest	Also declining at end	COMMERCIAL (still)

Source: Cantner, Doerr, Goethner et al. (2024), *Small Business Economics*, 62, 1555–1590. n = 1,149 scientists. Dominance analysis method.

3. Ecosystem Dependency: Knowledge and Talent

Deep tech commercialization is fundamentally an ecosystem-level phenomenon. The success of an individual venture depends less on its own qualities than on the surrounding infrastructure of research institutions, talent pools, and support programs.

3.1 Regional Determinants of Deep Tech Concentration

Raff-Heinen et al. (2026) analyzed 272 European NUTS-2 regions and identified 1,605 deep tech startups (4.5% of all startups in the sample). Negative binomial regression with text-analysis-based startup classification (96% accuracy).

Regional Factor	IRR	Significant?	Meaning
Knowledge infrastructure	1.48	YES	+1 SD in knowledge → 48% increase in deep tech concentration above mean
Talent pools (R&D FTE share)	1.66	YES	+1 SD in talent → 66% increase, strongest predictor
Formal institutions (policy, IP law)	,	NO	Government R&D spending and IP protection NOT significant
Generic ecosystem quality	Diminishing	Weak	Generic startup ecosystem quality alone is insufficient

IRR = Incidence Rate Ratio from Poisson regression. Source: Raff-Heinen et al. (2026), J. Technology Transfer. n = 272 regions, 1,605 deep tech startups.

3.2 Geographic Concentration

Metric	Value	Source
Top 10 EU regions share of all deep tech startups	40%	Raff-Heinen 2026
Cambridge: overall startup rank → deep tech rank	26th → 9th (14.5% deep tech share vs 4.5% avg)	Raff-Heinen 2026
UK deep tech geographic concentration in England	87.2%	RAEng/Beauhurst 2023
UK deep tech companies still at seed stage	50.5%	RAEng/Beauhurst 2023

4. Incubation Effectiveness: Meta-Analysis

Seitz et al. (2026) conducted the most comprehensive meta-analysis of incubation program effectiveness to date: 22 studies yielding 65 effect sizes, covering approximately 37,000 ventures (~3,400 incubated, ~32,000+ control). Random-effects model using Pearson r .

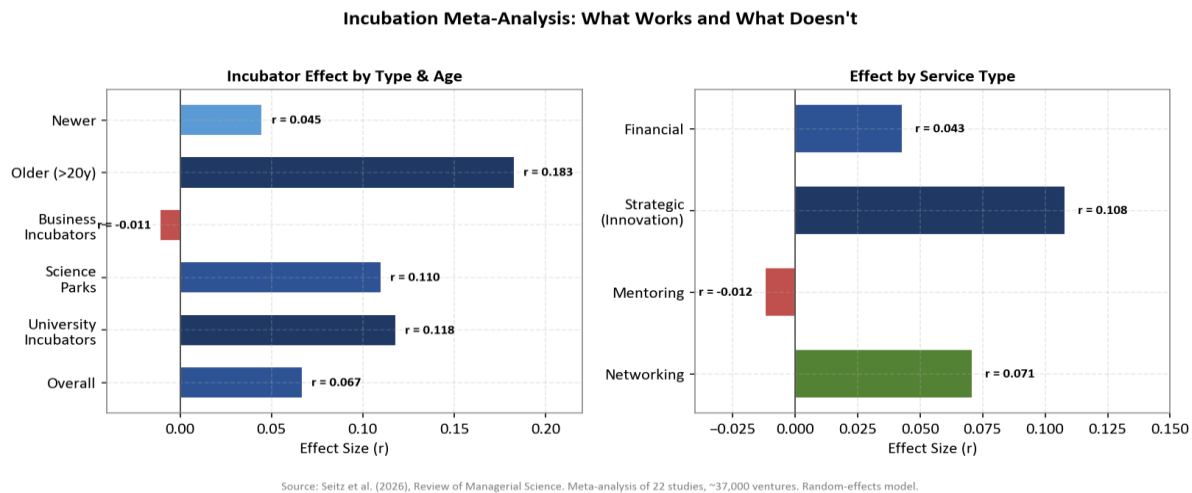


Figure 2. Left: effect size by incubator type and age. Right: effect by service type. Source: Seitz et al. (2026), Review of Managerial Science.

4.1 Full Decomposition of Effects

Moderator	r	p-value	Interpretation
Overall effect	0.067	0.004	Small but statistically significant positive
University incubators	0.118	Significant	Nearly double the overall effect
Science parks	0.110	Significant	Similar to university incubators
Business incubators (generic)	-0.011	Not significant	Generic incubation does NOT help
Older incubators (>20 years)	0.183	Significant	Triple the overall effect , maturity matters
Technology/R&D ventures	0.082–0.130	Significant	Deep tech ventures benefit more than average
Networking service	0.071	Significant	Most common and effective service
Mentoring service	-0.012	Not significant	Slightly NEGATIVE , opportunity cost
Strategic performance (innovation)	0.108	Significant	Strongest outcome dimension
Financial performance	0.043	Weak	Weakest outcome dimension
Public sponsorship	0.079	Significant	Better than non-sponsored ($r = 0.001$)
Private incubators	0.100	Significant	Better than public ($r = 0.060$)
North American studies	0.156	Significant	Strongest regional effect

5. Advisor Effects: Business vs Technology Advisors

One of the most actionable findings: advisor TYPE matters more than advisor quantity. Denoo, Van Boxstael, and Belz (2024) collected longitudinal data from 112 science-based ventures at US universities and introduced a novel outcome measure called 'application readiness' (AR), a 6-step scale capturing progress in both technology discovery and market identification.

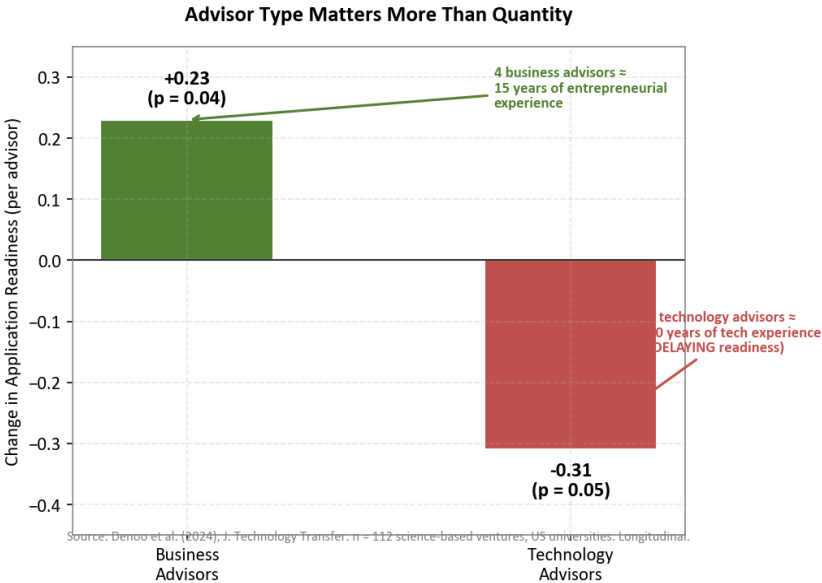


Figure 3. Effect of each additional advisor type on application readiness. Source: Denoo et al. (2024), J. Technology Transfer, 49, 1567–1705. n = 112 science-based ventures.

5.1 Detailed Results

Hypothesis	Finding	Coefficient	p-value	Status
H1a: Business advisors → +AR	Each business advisor increases AR	+0.23 per advisor	0.04	SUPPORTED
H1b: Technology advisors → -AR	Each technology advisor decreases AR	-0.31 per advisor	0.05	SUPPORTED
H2: Similar domain moderates	Tech advisor × tech experience: negative	-0.18	0.04	SUPPORTED
H2 (opposite): Business adv × entrepreneur exp	Positive moderation	+0.38	<0.005	OPPOSITE to prediction
H3: Knowledge variety	Tech adv × entrepreneur exp: negative	+0.48	<0.005	OPPOSITE to prediction

5.2 Magnitude Comparison: Advisors vs Experience

Resource	Effect on Application Readiness	Equivalence
1 additional business advisor	+0.23 AR units	,
4 business advisors	+0.92 ≈ +1 full AR unit	Equivalent to ~15 years of entrepreneurial experience
1 additional technology advisor	-0.31 AR units	,
3 technology advisors	-0.93 ≈ -1 full AR unit	Equivalent to ~20 years of technology experience (DELAYING)

Over 80% of ventures in the study used at least one advisor, making advisory relationships a ubiquitous policy tool. The findings suggest that limiting technology advisors and prioritizing business/market advisors is counterintuitive but evidence-based for physics-based ventures.

6. TTO Effectiveness: What Predicts Survival

A 15-year longitudinal study of 231 Japanese university spin-offs (one of the longest observation windows in the spin-off literature) used Cox proportional hazards survival analysis to identify which TTO activities predict venture survival.

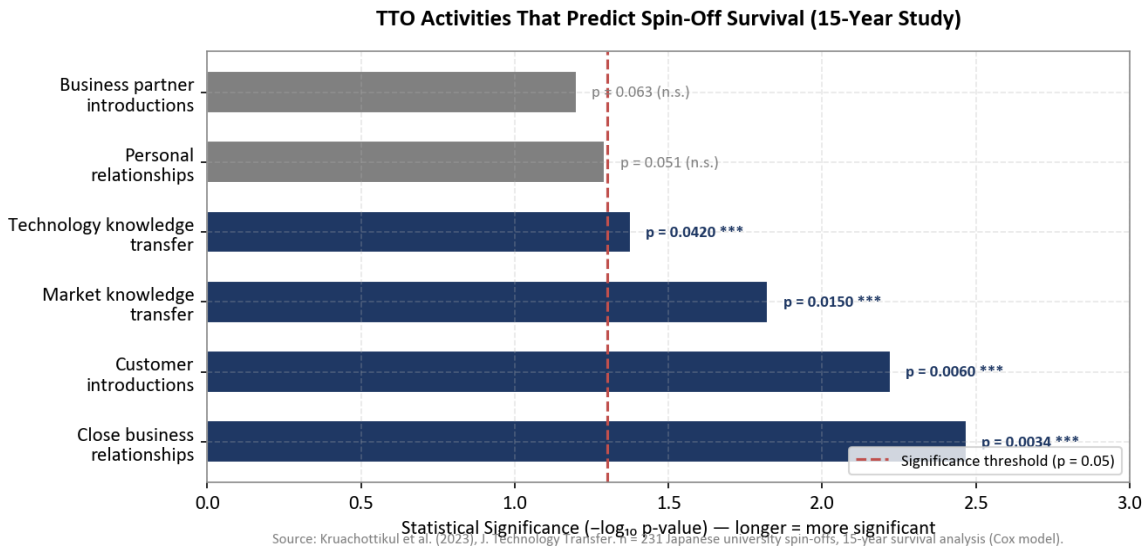


Figure 4. Statistical significance of TTO activities predicting spin-off survival. Longer bars = more significant. Source: Kruachottikul et al. (2023), J. Technology Transfer. n = 231, 15-year panel.

6.1 Full Survival Analysis Results

TTO Activity	p-value	Significant?	Effect direction
Close business relationships maintained by TTO	0.0034	YES ***	Reduces bankruptcy risk
Customer introductions	0.006	YES ***	Reduces bankruptcy risk
Market/customer knowledge sharing	0.015	YES **	Reduces bankruptcy risk
Technology knowledge sharing	0.042	YES *	Reduces bankruptcy risk
Close personal relationships	0.051	Marginal	Not significant at p<0.05
Business partner introductions	0.063	Not significant	,

Key insight: The activities cluster in a clear hierarchy , relational and market-oriented support (relationships, customer intros, market knowledge) matters MORE than technical support (technology knowledge transfer). Professionalism in relationships beats personal rapport.

6.2 TTO Specialization: Depth vs Breadth

Martínez-Ardila et al. (2023) analyzed 108 US universities generating 2,386 spin-offs. Negative binomial regression on panel data.

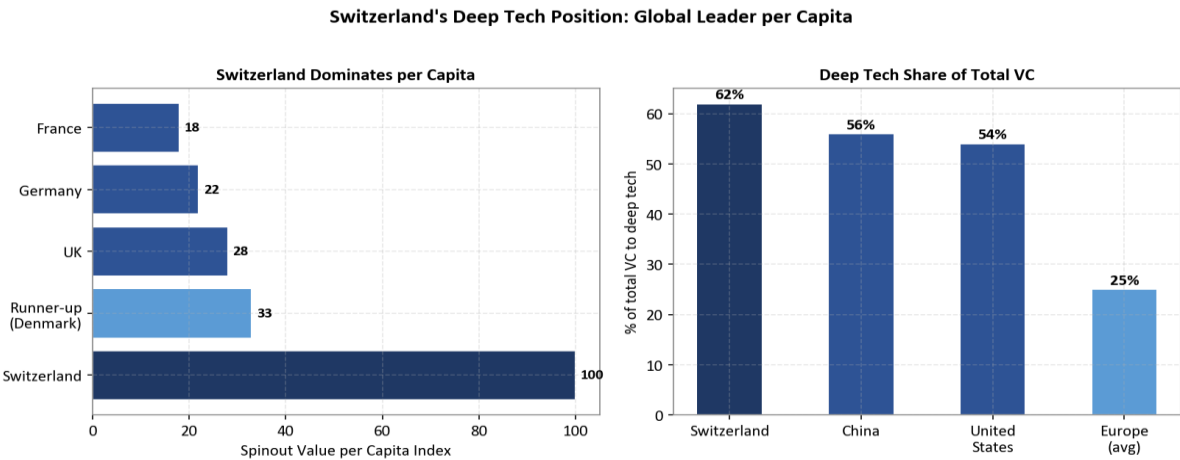
Dimension	Coefficient	Interpretation
TTO depth (specialization in specific domains)	1.273 (p<0.01)	+1 SD in specialization → 127% increase in spin-off performance
TTO breadth (diversification across many domains)	0.035 (p<0.01)	+1 SD in breadth → only 3.5% increase

Dimension	Coefficient	Interpretation
University reputation (top-15 Shanghai)	Not significant	Reputation does NOT matter when collaboration variables are included
TTO experience, patenting intensity, medical school	Significant positive	Consistently predict spin-off creation

Source: Martínez-Ardila et al. (2023), Heliyon (PMC). n = 108 US universities, 2,386 spin-offs (2014–2017).

7. Swiss Ecosystem: Performance and Positioning

The European Spinout Report 2025 (Dealroom.co + Deep Tech Nation Switzerland) provides the most current comparative data on spinout performance across Europe. Switzerland's position is dominant.



Source: Deep Tech Nation Switzerland / Dealroom.co (2025), European Spinout Report 2025.

Figure 5. Left: spinout value per capita index. Right: share of total VC allocated to deep tech. Source: Dealroom.co / DTN (2025).

7.1 Swiss Rankings and Key Metrics

Metric	Value	Rank/Context	Source
Spinout value per capita index	100 (runner-up: 33)	#1 in Europe (3× runner-up)	DTN 2025
Total combined enterprise value	\$44.6 billion	#3 in Europe (behind UK, Germany)	DTN 2025
ETH Zurich , spinout value	,	#3 in Europe	DTN 2025
EPFL , spinout value	,	#4 in Europe	DTN 2025
University of Zurich , spinout value	,	#8 in Europe	DTN 2025
ETH , robotics spinouts	41 VC-backed	#1 in Europe	DTN 2025
ETH , climate tech spinouts	,	#1 in Europe	DTN 2025
Deep tech share of Swiss VC	60–63%	#1 globally (ahead of China 56%, US 54%)	DTN 2025
Swiss VC raised H1 2025	CHF 1.47 billion	+36% year-on-year	DTN 2025
Total Swiss VC 2024	CHF 2.95 billion	,	DTN 2025
Spinout exits >\$1B in 2025	3 of 6 global were Swiss	Araris, Nexthink, ublox	DTN 2025
Spinouts = % of new DT/life science startups	40% since 2019	+80% vs previous decade	DTN 2025

7.2 Swiss Institutional Assets

Institution	Key data	Source
ETH transfer	37–43 spin-offs/year. Spin-offs raised CHF 425M in 2024. Portfolio valued ~CHF 10B. 2% equity, 6–8 week IP licensing process.	ETH Board
EPFL Innogrant	CHF 100,000 for one year of salary for future entrepreneur developing a spin-off while hosted at EPFL lab.	EPFL

Institution	Key data	Source
PSI TTO (John Millard)	20+ spin-offs. DECTRIS (2006, X-ray detectors → global leader), SwissNeutronics (1999), novoMOF (2017), GratXray (2017).	PSI
CERN KT 2025	89 KT contracts. CVC: 0% equity, 60 partners across 18 countries, 8 startups joined 2025.	CERN

8. Innosuisse: Instrument-Level Performance Data

The Innosuisse Impact Monitor (2021–2023) provides the most granular outcome data of any source in the evidence base. Data is self-assessment by funding recipients (response rates ~70% at completion, declining to <50% at 3-year follow-up).

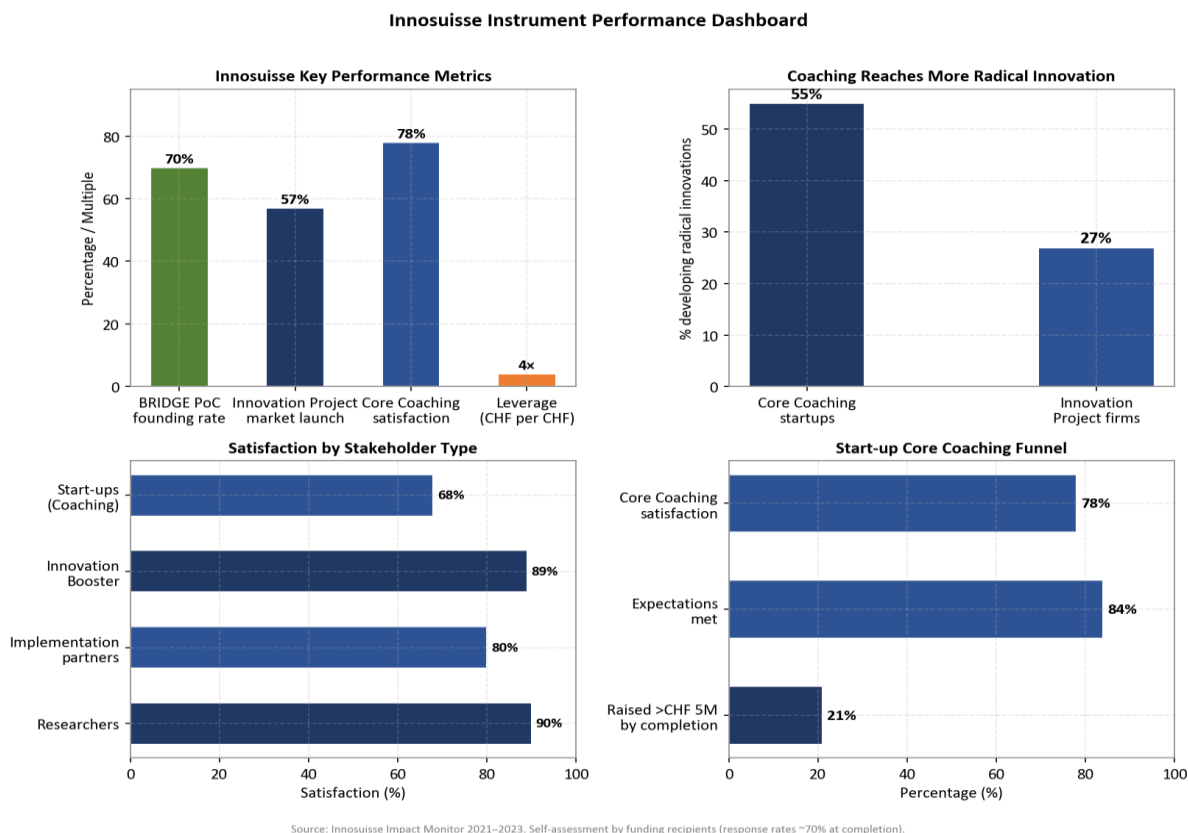


Figure 6. Innosuisse instrument performance dashboard. Source: Innosuisse Impact Monitor 2021–2023.

8.1 Innovation Projects (with Implementation Partners)

Metric	Value	Notes
Market launch rate (within 3 years post-funding)	57%	Funded innovations launched, implemented, or scheduled
Job creation per project	2.5 new highly qualified jobs	~800–900 FTEs created over 3-year cohort
Leverage effect	1 CHF → 4 CHF value added	Measured 3 years post-funding, totaled over 3 further years
Research partnership continuity	~50%	Continue working with research partner 3 years post-funding
Knowledge transfer (staff hiring)	15%	Firms hiring research staff from the project

8.2 BRIDGE Proof of Concept (Innosuisse + SNSF)

Metric	Value	Notes
Founding rate	70%	Of funded researchers who go on to found a startup/spin-off

Metric	Value	Notes
Funding amount	CHF 130,000	Over 12 months
Purpose	Develop research results into marketable products	Prepare for career outside academia
Evaluation	econcept AG: 80 startups from 121 PoC projects	Independent evaluation

8.3 Start-up Core Coaching

Metric	Value
Satisfaction (significant contribution to development)	78%
Expectations mostly met	84%
Raised >CHF 5M by completion	21%
Received helpful fundraising support	67%
Developing radical innovations	55% (vs 27% in innovation projects)

9. Innosuisse: Causal Effect (KOF DiD Study)

The KOF ETH Zurich causal study (Hulfeld, Spescha, and Wörter, November 2024) is the only independently verified causal estimate of Innosuisse effectiveness. It uses difference-in-differences methodology with a matched control group of 537 non-funded firms, analyzing 3,220 firm-year observations across 920 unique firms (383 funded, 537 control).

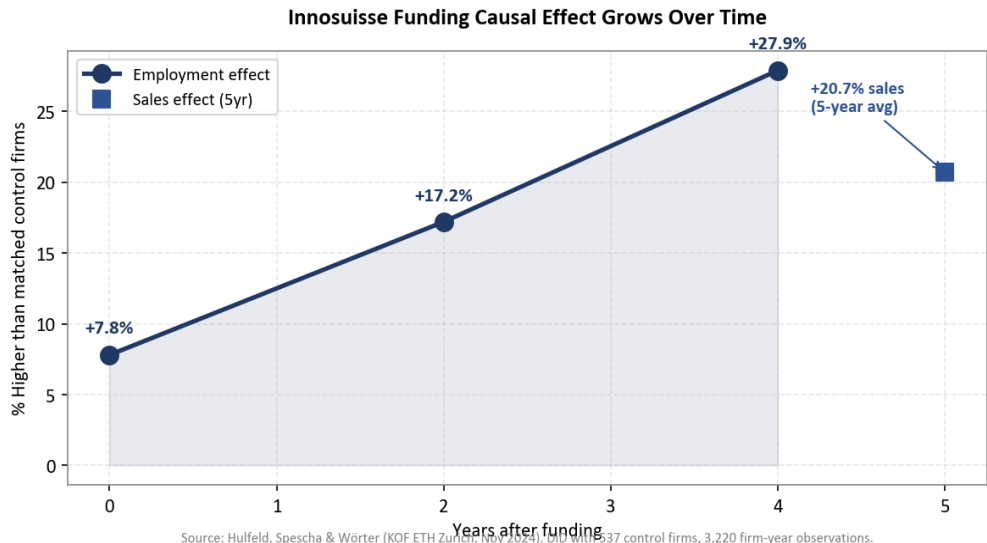


Figure 7. Innosuisse funding causal effect on employment over time. Source: Hulfeld et al. (KOF ETH Zurich, Nov 2024).

9.1 Detailed Causal Estimates

Outcome	Effect	Time horizon	Notes
Sales	+20.7%	5-year cumulative	Average across all funded firms
Employment	+17.6%	5-year cumulative	Average across all funded firms
Employment (Year 0)	+7.8%	Year of funding	Immediate effect
Employment (Year 2)	+17.2%	Two years post-funding	Growing
Employment (Year 4)	+27.9%	Four years post-funding	Effects accelerate over time

9.2 Where Effects Are Strongest

Moderator	Finding
Firm size	Strongest and statistically significant only for SMALL firms (5–50 employees)
Research partner type	Driven by projects where ETH Domain or universities of applied sciences serve as research partner
Selection correction	DiD with matched controls addresses both self-selection and Innosuisse selection bias

10. Framework Comparison: TRL Coverage and Scoring

The central finding of the framework assessment: every framework has a structural gap at TRL 1–3, which is precisely where NCCR Muoniverse operates.

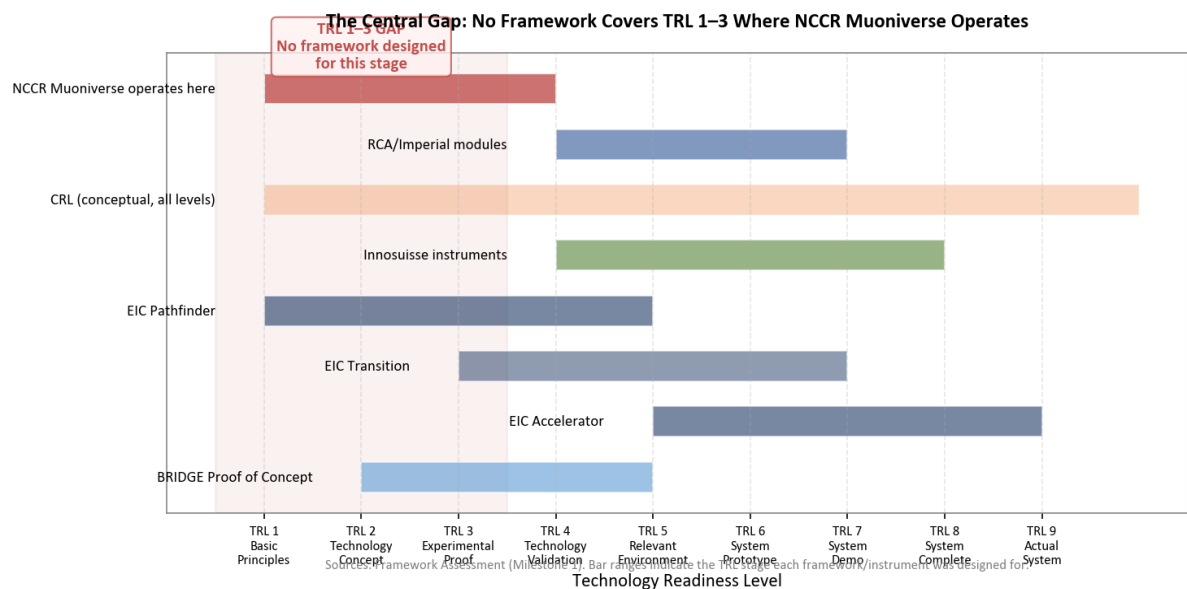


Figure 8. TRL coverage of each framework/instrument. Red zone marks the TRL 1–3 gap. Source: Framework Assessment (Milestone 1).

10.1 Framework Scoring Across Dimensions

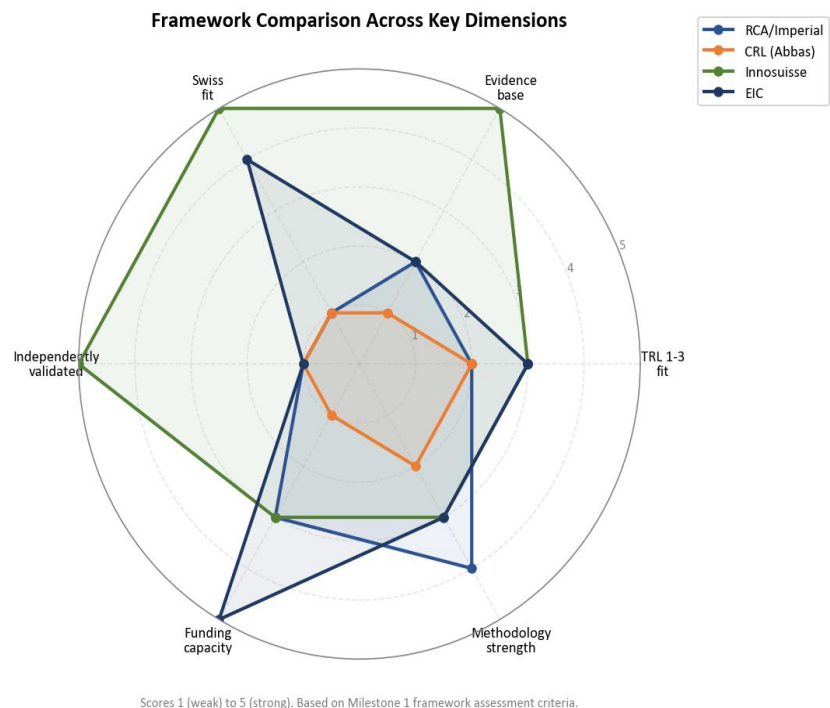


Figure 9. Framework comparison radar (scores 1–5). Source: Framework Assessment criteria.

10.2 Detailed Comparison Table

Criterion	RCA/Imperial	CRL (Abbas)	Innosuisse	EIC
TRL stage designed for	4–6	1–9 (all)	4–7	1–8 (pipeline)
Evidence base	Pedagogical	Proprietary consultancy	KOF-verified causal	Self-reported impact
Swiss fit	Low (UK institution)	N/A (assessment tool)	Native (Swiss agency)	High (since Jan 2025)
TRL 1–3 applicability	Weak	Conceptual only	Moderate (BRIDGE PoC)	Moderate (Pathfinder)
Independently validated	No	No	Yes (KOF DiD study)	No
Peer-reviewed?	No	No	KOF study: working paper	No
DOI/ISBN?	No	No	KOF Study No. 179	No
Assessment methodology published?	No	No	Yes (SAFIG Act)	Yes (Work Programme)

11. Europe vs US: Structural Barriers

Stryber (2025), with expert interviews from CERN, ETH AI Center, and Fraunhofer Venture, maps the structural barriers that differentiate European from US deep tech ecosystems. These are cultural and structural , they cannot be solved by adding capital alone.

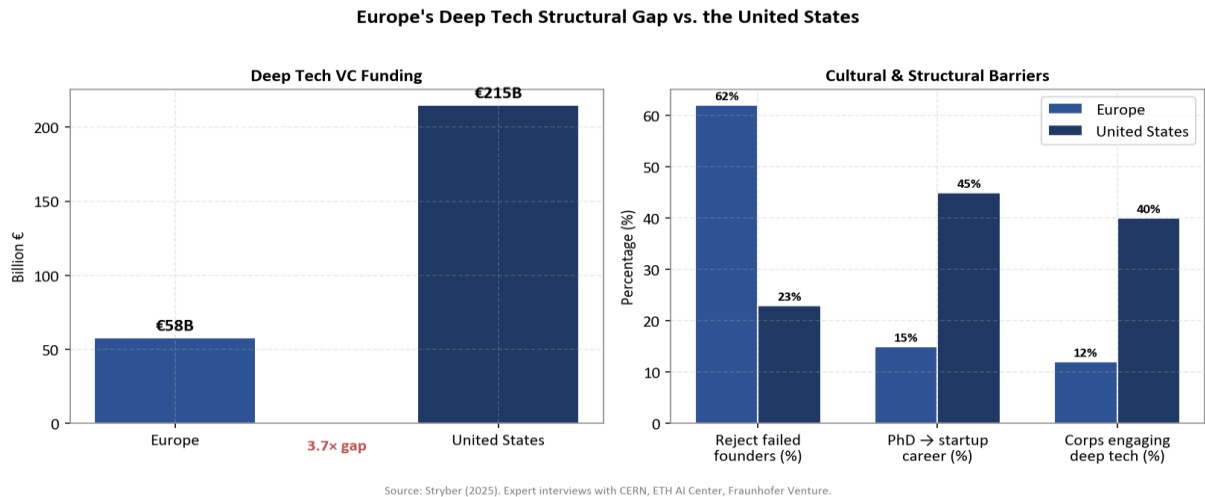


Figure 10. Left: deep tech VC funding gap. Right: cultural barriers. Source: Stryber (2025).

11.1 Barrier Detail

Barrier	Europe	United States	Ratio/Gap
Deep tech VC funding	€58 billion	€215 billion	3.7× gap
Investors rejecting failed founders	62%	23%	2.7× more risk-averse
PhD graduates pursuing startup careers	15%	45%	3.0× gap
Corporations engaging deep tech startups	12%	40%	3.3× gap
US share of global deep tech VC	,	49%	US dominates globally

11.2 European Deep Tech Funding Trajectory

Metric	2010	2023	Source
Deep tech share of European VC	10%	44%	UNDP 2025
Deep tech share of global VC	~10%	~20%	UNDP 2025

12. Deep Tech Resource Requirements

Deep tech ventures are fundamentally different from software/conventional startups in their resource intensity. These figures contextualize why conventional support instruments fail them.

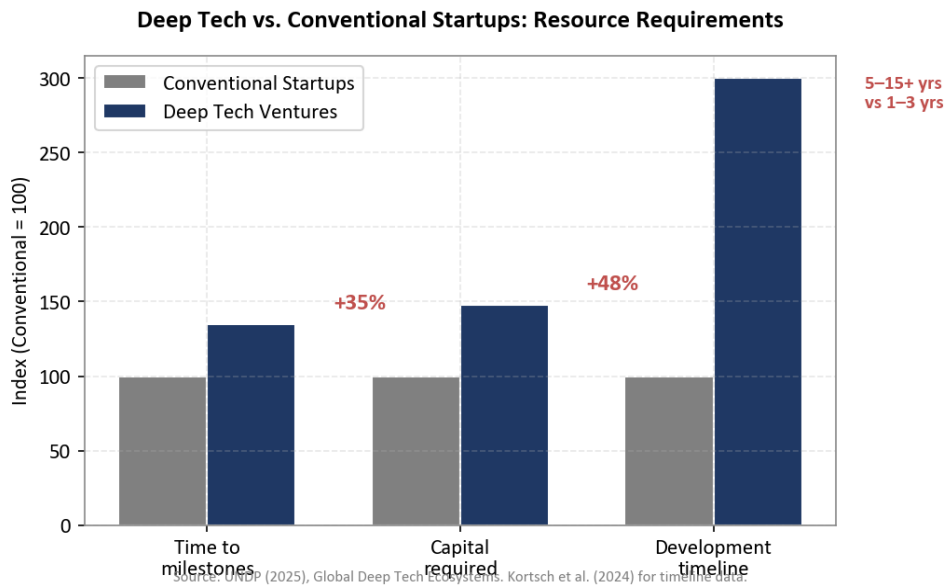


Figure 11. Deep tech vs conventional startup resource requirements. Source: UNDP (2025); Kortsch et al. (2024).

Dimension	Conventional Startups	Deep Tech Ventures	Premium	Source
Time to milestones	Baseline (100)	135	+35%	UNDP 2025
Capital required	Baseline (100)	148	+48%	UNDP 2025
Development timeline	1–3 years	5–15+ years	3–5× longer	Kortsch 2024
Technical uncertainty	Moderate	Multi-layered	Qualitatively different	Kortsch 2024
Commercial uncertainty	Moderate	Market may not exist	Qualitatively different	Subramanian 2024
SDG contribution	Variable	97% contribute to ≥1 SDG	,	UNDP 2025

13. Complete Evidence Table (Core Sources)

The following table lists all core sources with their key statistical findings. This is the raw data underlying the thematic synthesis in the Literature Review.

#	Authors (Year)	Method / Sample	Key Statistical Finding	TRL
1	Raff-Heinen et al. (2026)	272 EU regions, 1,605 DT startups, regression	Knowledge IRR=1.48, Talent IRR=1.66, Formal institutions NOT sig.	1–4
2	Seitz et al. (2026)	Meta-analysis, 22 studies, ~37,000 ventures	Overall $r=0.067$; University $r=0.118$; Mentoring $r=-0.012$; Older $r=0.183$	Seed+
3	Kruachottikul et al. (2023)	231 Japanese spin-offs, 15-yr survival analysis	TTO relationships $p=0.0034$; Customer intros $p=0.006$; Tech knowledge $p=0.042$	3–5
4	Martínez-Ardila et al. (2023)	108 US universities, 2,386 spin-offs	TTO depth coeff=1.273 vs breadth 0.035; University reputation NOT sig.	Early
5	Foresight (2024)	110 EU DT companies, PLS-SEM	Market $\beta=0.514$, Tech $\beta=0.310$, Env $\beta=0.306$, Firm internal NOT sig. $R^2=0.47$	4–8
6	Denoo et al. (2024)	112 science-based ventures, longitudinal	Business advisors +0.23 AR ($p=0.04$); Technology advisors -0.31 AR ($p=0.05$)	Early
7	Cantner et al. (2024)	1,149 scientists, dominance analysis	Commercial sphere > academic sphere from day one of spin-off creation	All
8	Chen et al. (2024)	Case study, Australasian universities	Playmaker vs go-between TTO typology; 5-stage process model	All
9	Hayter et al. (2025)	Cross-case analysis, 8 countries	I-Corps adapted in 8 countries; structured frameworks work but need local adaptation	1–4
10	Kortsch et al. (2024)	35 sources + 17 interviews, MIT Sloan	12 attributes of deep tech; 5–15+ year timelines; 3 levels (tech/venture/ecosystem)	All
11	Stahl et al. (2023)	14 startups, fsQCA	5 orchestration functions; 3 effective configurations; no single function sufficient	Early
12	Stryber (2025)	Expert interviews (CERN, ETH, Fraunhofer)	EU €58B vs US €215B DT VC; 62% EU reject failed founders vs 23% US	1–5
13	UNDP (2025)	Global landscape mapping	DT requires +35% time, +48% capital; 97% contribute to ≥ 1 SDG	3–5
14	Hello Tomorrow (2019)	100+ DT startups surveyed	Mentors 64%, Customer intros 61%, Investment 37% most valued	3–5
15	Kruachottikul (2023) Stage-Gate	3 deep-tech cases, Thailand	6 stages, 5 gates; all 3 cases achieved commercialization	1–4
16	VentureWell (2019)	500+ practitioners	6 dimensions $\times$ 5 stages $\times$ 3 pathways; explicit abandon pathway	Early+
17	Cabanes (2026)	Conceptual synthesis	Deep tech = performative innovation regime; 4 defining characteristics	All

13.1 Institutional Sources

Source	Key Data Point
Innosuisse Impact Monitor 2021–2023	57% market launch; 4 $\times$ leverage; 70% BRIDGE PoC founding rate; 78% coaching satisfaction
KOF ETH Zurich (Hulfeld et al. 2024)	+20.7% sales, +17.6% employment (DiD, 5yr). Strongest for small firms + ETH Domain partners

Source	Key Data Point
KOF/SBFI (Wörter et al. 2024)	Swiss WTT functions 'relatively well'; industry R&D in university sector doubled
CERN KT Highlights 2025	89 KT contracts; CVC 0% equity, 60 partners/18 countries; 8 startups joined 2025
DTN/Dealroom 2025	Switzerland #1 per capita (100 vs 33); ETH #3, EPFL #4; 60–63% of Swiss VC to deep tech
EIC Impact Report 2025	€1B invested, €2.6B co-invested (3:1); 706 startups; 52.5% employment growth

14. Source List

All sources directly accessed and verified during June–July 2026. No data has been fabricated or extrapolated.

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